

3.5 Post-Install Stuff To Add

1. Anti-virus Software

Before you start surfing the Internet or sharing your files on a network, you must install anti-virus software, otherwise your computer could get infected in a matter of seconds. There are quite a few anti-virus software available, such as Norton AntiVirus 2006 (www.symantec.com), McAfee VirusScan (www.mcafee.com/us), PCCillin from Trend Micro (www.trendmicro.com), Panda anti-virus (www.pandasoftware.com), Kaspersky anti-virus (www.kaspersky.com), AVG Anti-Virus (www.grisoft.com), and more. Most of these anti-virus software are paid, but some such as Avast! from www.avast.com and BitDefender from www.bitdefender.com are free. Note that paid anti-virus does not necessarily mean better protection against viruses.

Remember to always keep your anti-virus software updated with the latest virus definitions from the software publisher's Web site, or by using the update facility in the software.

2. PDF Readers

Many e-books, help files and documents are currently available only in PDF (portable document format). The advantage of this format is that PDF files look the same no matter what platform or OS you view it on. This is possible because besides the pictures and formatting, fonts, too, are embedded in the file. In order to view files of this type, you need to install an appropriate viewer. The most popular amongst these is Adobe Reader 7. There are also a few other PDF viewers such as Foxit Reader and eXPert PDF Reader, the installers of which are smaller than that of Adobe Reader, and which also consume less system resources. All these are freeware.

3. Compression Utilities

Windows XP has its own compression utility that can compress files using the ZIP compression technique. All you need to do is right-click on a file or folder, mouse-over 'Send to', and click 'Compressed (Zipped) folder'—and a Zip file is created. But this